

MOUNTAIN REFUGE

Written by Alex Rivera

INT. MOUNTAIN CABIN - NIGHT

A blizzard howls outside the frosted windows. Thick drifts pile against the heavy wooden door.

MARCUS (40s, rugged, weathered by years in the backcountry) stokes the hearth fire. The orange embers illuminate rough-hewn pine timbers.

He crosses to the vintage refrigerator in the corner, reaches into the bottom shelf, and pulls out a frosty can of Coors Light.

The silver and blue mountains on the aluminum can catch the firelight. He cracks the tab with a sharp, echoing hiss and takes a slow, deep pull.

MARCUS

Cold as the Rockies. Exactly what I needed tonight.

EXT. RIDGE OVERLOOK - DAY

The morning sun crests over the snow-capped jagged peaks of the Continental Divide, blindingly bright against the fresh powder.

SARAH (30s, sharp-eyed, equipped with mountaineering gear) kneels in the snow, calibrating an electronic telemetry sensor.

Marcus hikes up the steep switchback carrying heavy expedition packs.

SARAH

We have less than three hours before the upper atmospheric front collides with the valley pressure system.

MARCUS

Then we move fast. We do not want to be caught on the open ridge when that wind hits.

INT. ABANDONED WEATHER STATION - DUSK

Shadows lengthen across rusted radar consoles, shattered oscilloscope screens, and stripped copper conduits. Sarah uses a pry bar to force open the backup generator housing. Marcus connects an auxiliary power cell.

SARAH

Generator coil is intact. If we can jump the primary fuse, the satellite array might still broadcast.

MARCUS

Powering the auxiliary relay now. Stand clear of the main breaker.

A high-pitched turbine whine fills the damp station room as indicator lamps flicker to life one by one.

The satellite uplink frequency locks at 100% signal strength. Coordinates transmit into the secure encrypted band.

SARAH

Transmission confirmed. Headquarters has the seismic packet.

MARCUS

Then our job here is done. Let us pack up and head down the mountain.

FADE OUT.